Hong Ong

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Professional Summary

Software Engineering (Honours) graduate from UTS (High Distinction average), with 9 months of production experience across two concurrent engineering projects: a Rails/React platform for OnlyFacts and a multi-region Astro/AWS site for The a2 Milk Company. Experienced in full-stack development, headless CMS architecture, CI/CD, and Agile delivery, with a track record of shipping and debugging production systems.

Work Experience

- **The a2 Milk Company (Contract via OnlyFacts)** — Sydney, NSW
  Software Developer — *June 2026 – Present*
  - Built pages and features across a multi-region SSR platform on Astro 5 (5 markets, 7 locales) and a dedicated Careers site, from a single codebase, using Kontent.ai headless CMS, Alpine.js, Algolia search, and Tailwind CSS, deployed on AWS via CloudFront, Elastic Beanstalk, and CodeBuild CI
  - Developed reusable, CMS-driven UI components and extended existing ones by modularising shared functionality across content types, reducing duplication
  - Diagnosed a failing production deployment by tracing it to a cancelled CodeBuild run, fixing the failing test, and pushing the build through to production
- **OnlyFacts** — Sydney, NSW
  Full-Stack Engineer (Contract) — *January 2026 – Present*
  - Refactored 1,300+ lines of legacy JavaScript and Ruby on Rails code, improving maintainability and aligning with modern OOP and clean architecture principles
  - Designed and delivered 2 production data visualisation features using D3.js, enabling real-time geographic data rendering for end users, collaborating with stakeholders to validate requirements and iterate on design
  - Redesigned 3 PostgreSQL database tables, improving relational integrity and optimising indexed queries to reduce data retrieval latency
  - Used AI-assisted development tooling (Claude Code) across refactoring and feature work, reviewing generated output against existing architecture patterns before merge; contributed to code reviews and pull request workflows within a cross-functional Agile team

  Software Engineering Intern — *November 2025 – January 2026*
  - Built and presented 3 feature prototypes to stakeholders, validating concepts that informed subsequent architecture and implementation decisions
  - Identified technical debt and maintainability issues in the legacy codebase and presented improvement recommendations adopted in later development
- **Optik Consultancy (Philips Dynalite)** — Sydney, NSW
  Software Engineering Consultant — *May 2024 – February 2025*
  - Led cross-functional teams of software and mechanical engineers to deliver automation solutions on time and within budget, collaborating with client stakeholders to translate requirements into technical designs
  - Programmed OMRON TM5 cobot using TM FLOW to automate relay/terminal placement, cutting production time by 40% and error rates by 60%

Education

- **University of Technology Sydney** — Sydney, NSW
  Bachelor of Engineering (Honours), Software Engineering — *February 2022 – December 2025*
  - WAM: 87.10 (High Distinction Average) | GPA: 6.59/7.0 | Dean's List 2024, 2025 & 2026 | Undergraduate Academic Excellence International Scholarship
  - Relevant Coursework: Database Fundamentals (100), Cloud Computing & SaaS (97), Software Innovation Studio (96), Software Analysis Studio (94), Software Architecture (93), Systems Testing and Quality Management (89)

Projects

- **VR Career Exploration: Lifeguard Simulation** August 2025 – December 2025
  Lead Programmer & VR Developer
  - Built immersive VR training simulation in Unity/C# using XR Interaction Toolkit; implemented a VR controller-based selection system with haptic, audio, and visual feedback cues, achieving 95% selection accuracy among first-time users during a live showcase
  - Developed a dynamic NPC system with randomised spawning; optimised performance for VR headsets using object pooling and reduced draw calls during NPC interactions, cutting frame drops by roughly 50% measured via Unity profiler
  - Led a 7-person Agile team, conducting code reviews and technical QA across 3D modelling, animation, and UI work
- **Thrive X Mobile App Prototype** February 2025 – April 2025
  Full-Stack Developer
  - Built a cross-platform mobile app in Flutter (Dart) integrating Google Gemini API to power AI-driven skill assessments and personalised feedback, spanning front-end, REST APIs, Firebase, and AI workflow orchestration
  - Implemented real-time data sync via Firebase (30% faster load times), RESTful API integration, and user authentication/profile management

Leadership Activities

- **UTS Malaysian and Singaporean Students' Association (MASSA)** Sydney, NSW
  Treasurer *November 2022 – June 2024*
  - Managed $40,000+ budget across 20+ events, consistently achieving break-even or profit targets through strategic financial planning and resource allocation

Technical Skills

- **Languages**: JavaScript, TypeScript, Ruby, Python, SQL, Java, C, C#, C++
- **Frameworks**: Ruby on Rails, ReactJS, Node.js, Astro, Alpine.js, Flutter, D3.js, Tailwind CSS
- **CMS & Search**: Kontent.ai (headless CMS), Algolia
- **APIs & Architecture**: RESTful API design & integration, MVC, object-oriented programming (OOP), background job processing (Heroku Scheduler)
- **Databases**: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Firebase Realtime Database
- **Cloud**: AWS (CloudFront, Elastic Beanstalk, CodeBuild, S3), Google Cloud Platform (GCP)
- **DevOps**: Git, GitHub, Docker, CI/CD pipelines (GitHub Actions, AWS CodeBuild), Agile/Scrum, VS Code, JetBrains Suite
- **Testing**: Unit & integration testing, test-driven development (TDD); pytest, Google Test (C++) from coursework and personal projects
- **AI & Developer Tooling**: Google Gemini, Claude (Claude Code), AI workflow integration, GitHub Actions automation

Languages

- **Spoken Languages**: English, French (Fluent); Vietnamese, Mandarin, Cantonese (Basic)